



Consistency in Architecture - communicating futurism

sion to our parties. However, the strictness of consistency required varies across the cross-section of levels. These levels include (in decreasing order of required strictness):

1. Interpretation of user behaviour: UX design involves programming product behaviour in response to actionable user behaviour (shortcuts, gestures, etc). This subconsciously creates learned scenarios of cause and effect in the user's brains: "If I do this, that happens." You do NOT want to mess with that, unless you're sabotaging the company you work for. Having to unlearn something is extremely frustrating, and is sure to drive away users rather than attract them and reinforce their usage. That said, conforming to an existing product's usage behaviours makes it easier to steal that product's recurring customers! Either way, within your own product cycles, be consistent with the interpretation of user behaviour.

2. Invisible structures: 'Invisible structures' refer to elements that are usually not apparently visible in the interface, but allow control and interaction with the program or product. These may be hidden scroll bars or a menu